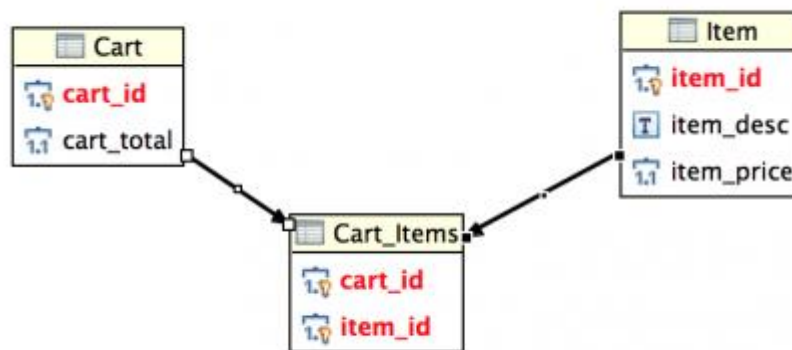


Hibernate Many to Many

Many-to-Many mapping is usually implemented in database using a **Join Table**.

- For example we can have **Cart** and **Item** table and **Cart Items** table for many-to-many mapping.
- Every cart can have multiple items and every item can be part of multiple carts, so we have a many to many mapping here.



- The annotation `@ManyToMany` is used to define many to many relationship.
- If we look into `@JoinTable`, it has the third table name configured as **Cart Items**
- The **CART ID** and **ITEM ID** will contain the primary key of table **CART** and **ITEM** respectively.

@JoinTable

- **@JoinTable should be used for entities linked through an association table.**
- @JoinTable annotation is used to join two table using a third table.
-
- Here, we use the **@JoinTable** annotation to specify the details of the join table (table name and two join columns - using the **@JoinColumn** annotation);
- Set the **cascade** attribute of the **@OneToMany** annotation so that Hibernate will update the associated articles when the category is updated.
- This third table associates two table by their Ids.
- To define @JoinTable we can use below attributes.
name: This is the name of third table.
joinColumns: Assign the column of third table related to entity itself.
inverseJoinColumns: Assign the column of third table related to associated entity.

@JoinTable annotation to specify the details of the **join table** (table name and two join columns - using the @JoinColumn annotation);

joinColumns: is just the name of the primary key that belongs to the primary Table

inversejoincolumn is just the name of the foreign key that belongs to the OTHER table